

Payment Reconciliation Guide

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Objective

Reconciliation identifies differences between transaction state, ledger state, external responses and settlement evidence.

Core controls

Check	Input	Expected	Exception
Transaction-to-ledger	Events + ledger	One financial outcome	Missing/duplicate entry
Switch-to-transaction	Switch response + state	Consistent final state	Unknown result
Settlement-to-ledger	Settlement + ledger	Amounts agree	Amount mismatch
Reversal-to-ledger	Reversal + ledger	Reversal balances original	Partial/duplicate

Unknown result handling

Do not infer failure from a timeout alone. Establish whether the external system has a definitive result. If not, keep the transaction in a controlled reconciliation state.

Evidence hierarchy

- Authoritative ledger entry
- Validated external response
- Settlement/reconciliation evidence
- Application logs
- Customer statement

RAG test hook

This document intentionally overlaps with the incident runbook and transaction processing guide.